

How do you justify the environmental cost of generative AI?

Posted by u/SeigneurLimerence • 0 points • 61 comments

Not asking in an antagonistic way, im genuinely curious. There are a few things that irritate me about AI art. One: most libraries/data banks etc that they draw from were created using art that the artists did not consent to being used for training AI. That bothers me a fair amount. I know that can be hard to regulate or even ask about, especially since I believe most is trained on just images a user submits? I don't really know though. Either way, the ethics of that irritate me, but art theft is nothing new in the art world either.

What bother me the most is the sheer amount of energy that servers hosting gen Ai use and its environmental effects. I know that can be a complicated subject too, just because there's so much we're already screwing over the planet with, but gen AI doesn't help. Are the figure just over inflated? Are there plans for more green energy usage from gen AI companies?

I'm not the most informed on this and really only know of the negatives, but I'd like a more nuanced view. I think gen AI has a lot of potential, it's just that the way things are run right now.... It isn't the best and we need a lot of changes for it to be truly beneficial.

Comments

u/Godgeneral0575 • 1 points • 2025-09-20 16:51 UTC

The same way I justify playing video games on my laptop.

It all runs on it.

u/EngineerBig1851 • 1 points • 2025-09-20 07:32 UTC

Easy. I skipped eating a burger once and now I have so much green leeway I can just use AI daily, for, like, a year.

And then i'll just skip eating another burger.

u/Fit-Elk1425 • 1 points • 2025-09-20 04:28 UTC

Another study though idealized you may want to look into is

<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-024-54271-x>

u/SlapstickMojo • 2 points • 2025-09-20 02:32 UTC

I would need to see a study and its data directly. Every chart I find varies so wildly they might as well be random. Training vs prompting, which model, which version, date, other server uses, power vs water, etc.

u/SeigneurLimerence • 1 points • 2025-09-20 02:35 UTC

I think any of the charts I've seen were very anti-AI biased. I'd like to see something more comprehensive too, but I guess that depends on the ethics of the company as well? Different ones have different ways of powering facilities etc so

Have already learned a lot from just asking here lol

u/Val_Fortecazzo • 2 points • 2025-09-20 02:28 UTC

How do you justify the environmental cost of shit posting on Reddit

u/SeigneurLimerence • 1 points • 2025-09-20 02:28 UTC

I'm not shitposting though :')

u/Nickanok • 4 points • 2025-09-20 02:24 UTC

Can we stop with this "The artist didn't consent". Yes most artists did. Period.

Unless you went through the proper legal channels of copyrighting your work, if you put something online, it's public property and can be used for whatever purpose. Making your profile private or captioning "You don't have the right to do this" does NOT hold up in court

You put something online, that's automatic consent

u/KallyWally • 1 points • 2025-09-20 05:55 UTC

You have copyright the moment you put your work to a fixed medium. You have to register it in order to sue for infringement, and doing so after the infringement limits the damages you can claim, but neglecting to register doesn't make your work public property.

u/SeigneurLimerence • 1 points • 2025-09-20 02:28 UTC

I was under the impression most hadn't. It's been a huge argument for a long time, I know. Genuinely not trying to be antagonistic with my questions >< I wanna learn more and read other viewpoints, so that's why I asked.

I'm not familiar with copyright law personally, but I was told a long time ago that there was a sort of copyright type thing applied to someone's work when they post it? But... thinking for more than two seconds, that doesn't make sense so.... Hmm.

u/Nickanok • 2 points • 2025-09-20 03:38 UTC

No. Unless you personally copyright it, it's fair game. I think there's some restrictions but Ai Generation is not one of them

Posting pictures on reddit or twitter can be downloaded and distributed and you have no legal recourse

